



Lessons

- Table of Contents
- Confidence Levels
- Notes
- Bookmarks
- Highlights

Tables

Tables

A **table** is often used to organize and display data, especially data that is classified by categories. A table may contain both words and numbers written in labeled rows and columns.

A **row** is read from left to right. A **column** is read from top to bottom.

Use the row and column headings to locate specific data in a table. The title of the table may also have important information.

Population of the Top 5 U.S. Cities (2000 and 2010) (in millions)

City	2000 Population	2010 Population	2010 Rank	Percent Change 2000–2010
Chicago, IL	2.89	2.69	3	−6.9%
Houston, TX	1.95	2.10	4	+ 7.5%
Los Angeles, CA	3.69	3.79	2	+ 2.6%
New York, NY	8.01	8.17	1	+ 2.1%
Philadelphia, PA	1.51	1.52	5	+ 0.6%

Example

Hide

In 2000, the population of New York City was about how many times larger than the population of Houston? Locate the place where the column labeled “2000 Population” and the row labeled “New York, NY” intersect.

City	2000 Population
Chicago, IL	2.89
Houston, TX	1.95
Los Angeles, CA	3.69
New York, NY	8.01
Philadelphia, PA	1.51

The value is 8.01. The title states that the values are in millions. The population of New York City was about 8.01 million in 2000. Now look for the row labeled “Houston, TX.” The population of Houston was about 1.95 million in 2000. $8.01 \div 1.95 \approx 8 \div 2 \approx 4$. The population of New York City was about **4 times** larger than the population of Houston in 2000.

You can also use the data in a table to draw conclusions. For example, look at the column labeled “Percent Change.” Chicago was the only city with a decreasing population. You could conclude that from 2000 to 2010, the populations of the largest U.S. cities primarily increased.

Key Terms

 **bar graph**

 **data bar**

 **row**

 **vertical axis**

 **column**

 **horizontal axis**

 **table**

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Category

Lesson 1: Graphs and Tables

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